

6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577

Historical Farming, Agricultural Use and Land-Clearing Evidence Summary

Date: 30 April 2026 | Property reviewed: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577; Lot 4 DP746930.

Executive conclusion. Based on the material reviewed, the evidence supports the position that the subject land sits within the historic Bong Bong / Bulwer-Lytton Road locality, an area recorded in Austermere Estate material as cleared, ploughable and suitable for agricultural, dairy, orchard and farming use by 1904. The contract of sale provides the modern title and map bridge connecting 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4 DP746930 to that older locality.

Scope Reviewed

This summary reviews the exchanged contract of sale, the title search and plans inside that contract, the planning certificate, NSW Cadastre data queried for Lot 4 DP746930, the 1904 Austermere Estate sale material, State Library subdivision-plan references, and previously located historical sources. It focuses on evidence that may support prior farming, agricultural use, grazing, orchard/dairy use, or historical clearing of the land.

Key Findings

Finding	Evidence / source	Strength
The modern property is Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Contract page 43 title search: Folio 4/746930, Lot 4 in DP746930, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Strong for legal identity.
DP746930 was created by subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 in 1987.	Contract scanned plan page 44: DP746930, "Subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513", Moss Vale, Bong Bong, Camden.	Strong for parent-title bridge.
The land is in the Bulwer Road / Lytton Road area.	Contract plan page 44 shows Lytton Road and road-widening context. NSW Cadastre polygon for Lot 4 DP746930 places the parcel beside Bulwer Road and north of Lytton Road.	Strong for location.
Austermere Estate material records agricultural/farming suitability and clearing by 1904.	NLA 1904 Austermere Estate plan and catalogue record describe land as "large area cleared & ready for plough" and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms.	Strong for wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality; not yet direct title-chain proof for Lot 4.
The contract does not directly say Lot 4 itself was farmed.	Search/OCR of contract text, title search, scanned Gazette pages and annexures found title/easement/planning material but no direct phrase such as "Lot 4 was farmed" or "cleared for agriculture".	Important limitation.

Contract Review

The contract is useful mainly as a title and location document. It identifies the sale land as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale, part of Lot 4 DP746930, with a proposed unregistered subdivision. The prescribed documents include title search material, an unregistered plan, the current deposited plan, older easement/title documents, Crown purchase-related material, and the 2023 planning certificate.

Relevant contract references:

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing question
Page 1	Identifies the property as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale; Lot 2 in an unregistered plan, part of Lot 4 DP746930; Part Folio Identifier 4/746930.	Confirms modern property identity.
Page 4	List of prescribed documents includes old system document and Crown purchase statement of account.	Shows deeper historical title material may exist beyond the bundle.

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing question
Page 43	Title search confirms Lot 4 DP746930 at Moss Vale, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Connects land to historical parish/county records.
Page 44	DP746930 plan shows subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513, registered in 1987, with Lytton Road and surrounding road geometry.	Gives key parent-title step before the modern lot.
Pages 232-248	Planning certificate confirms current E4 General Industrial zoning and that agriculture/farm buildings are prohibited under current zoning.	Current zoning does not prove historic use.

Historical Farming / Clearing Evidence

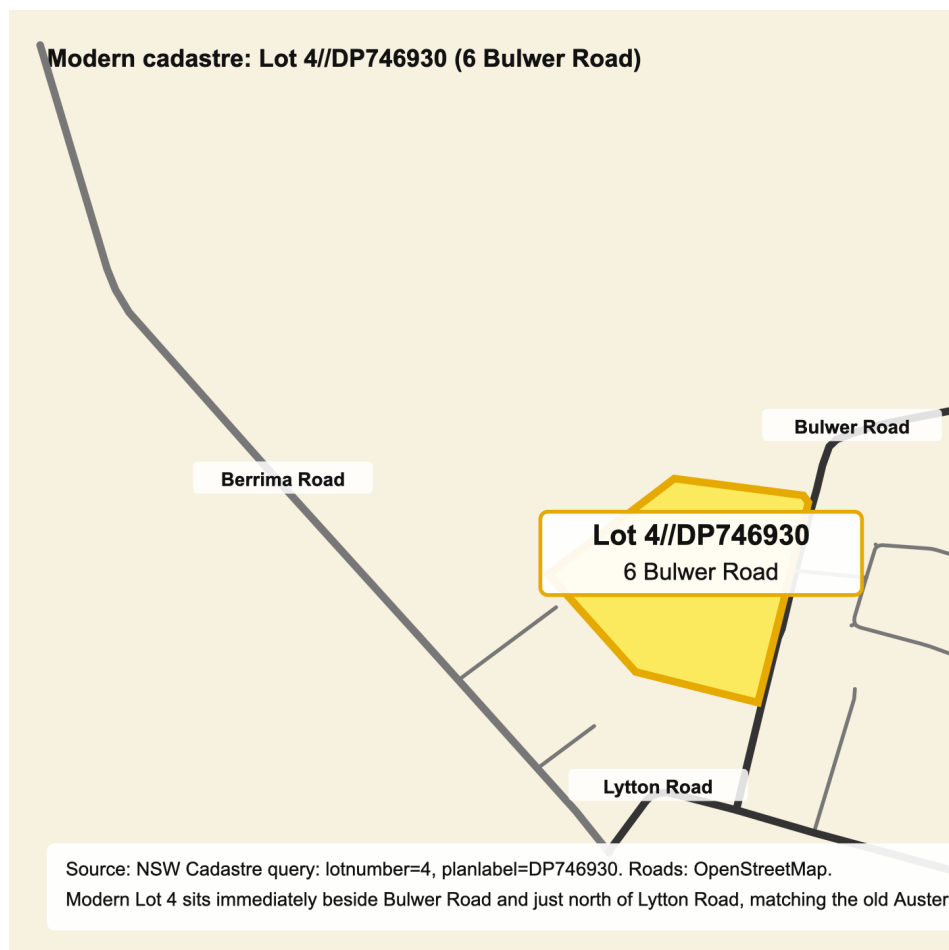
The best direct historical evidence remains the Austermere Estate sale material. The 1904 sale plan for Moss Vale Austermere Estate describes the estate as including a “large area cleared & ready for plough” and markets the land for residential sites, orchard blocks, dairy and agricultural farms. Separate NLA/State Library references also describe Austermere material as suitable for farming, dairying, grazing and market gardens. This supports a defensible “cleared by at least 1904” position for the wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality.

Evidence Strength Matrix

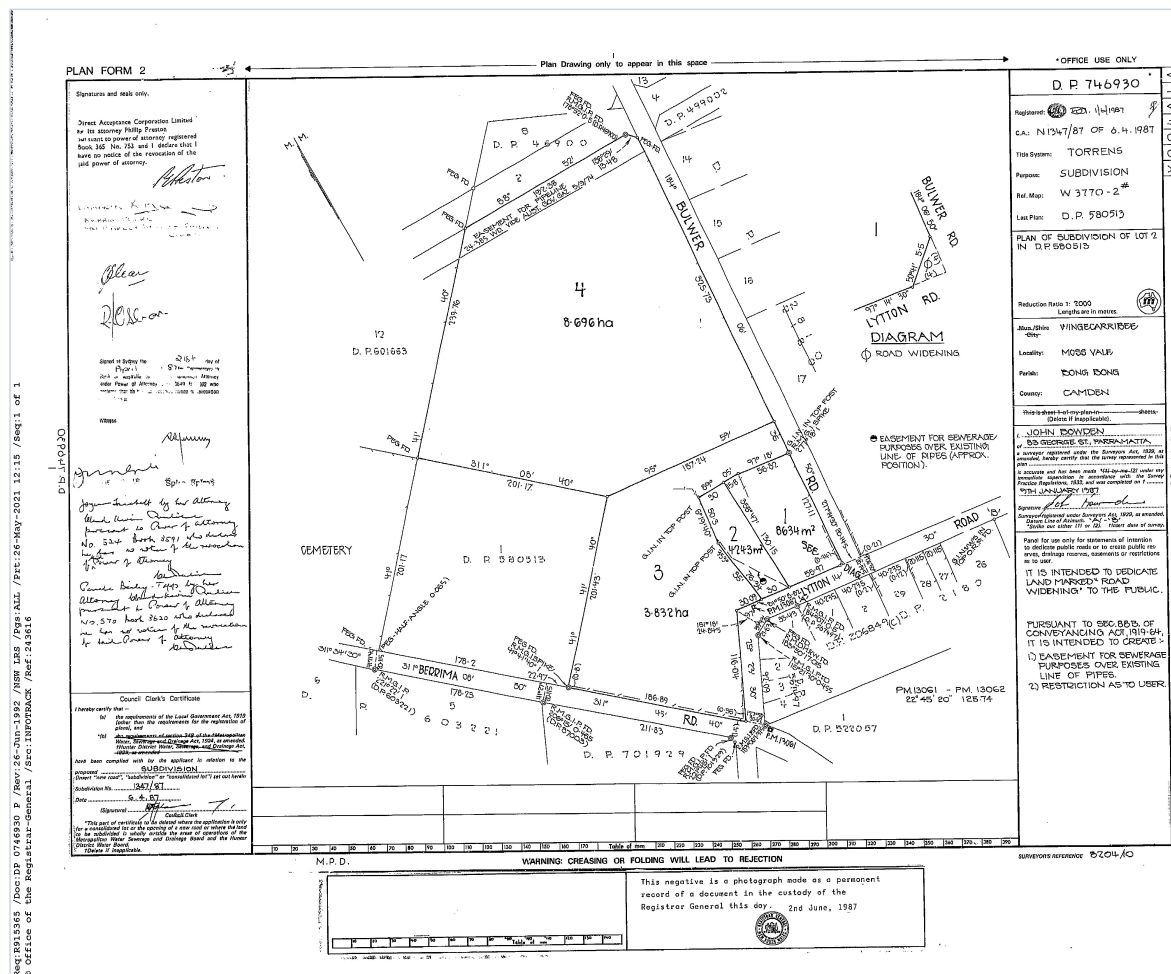
Evidence item	What the evidence supports
Contract title search	Confirms the legal identity of the land as Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.
DP746930 plan	Shows modern Lot 4 was created from Lot 2 DP580513 and places the land around the Lytton/Bulwer Road area.
NSW Cadastre overlay	Places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road, aligning the modern parcel with the historical Bulwer/Lytton locality.
Austermere 1904 material	Records the historical Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farming by 1904.
Historical aerial imagery, next research step	Can add visual confirmation of open paddock/farmland character and later disturbance periods across the subject parcel and surrounding locality.

Visual Exhibit A: Modern Cadastre Overlay

NSW Cadastre data queried for lotnumber=4 and planlabel=DP746930 places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road.



Note: visual prepared from NSW Cadastre Feature Layer geometry and OpenStreetMap road geometry for orientation.



Austermere Estate 1904 - Original Listing Evidence

Source: National Library of Australia, Moss Vale Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904. NLA object nla.obj-230332818.

The full original 1904 Austermere Estate sale listing is shown vertically so the whole listing and plan can be viewed together. The material promotes 'Orchard Blocks, Dairy & Agricultural Farms' and records a 'large area cleared & ready for plough', supporting agricultural use, land clearing and farming suitability in the wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality by 1904.

MOSS VALE AUSTERMERE ESTATE

Well known as the 4000 ACRES
Property of the late Sir John Lackey

Within 25 Chains of **MOSSVALE RAILY STN** Bong Bong Raily Plat^{fm} on the Estate
5 Miles of River frontage

Frontages to Railway Line also to **BOWRAL & BERRIMA** Main Roads

Undulating Land, Good Soil.
well watered, large area cleared &
ready for plough. Residential Sites
Orchard Blocks, Dairy & Agricultural farms.

AUCTION SALE SATURDAY at 2.0'C.
ON THE ESTATE **26th NOVEMBER**
1904

"TORRENS" TITLE

TERMS
 10 per cent Deposit.
 5 per cent in 6 Months.
 Balance by ten 1/2 yearly payments,
 with 5 per cent Interest.
 with right to pay off at any time.

REASONABLE PRICES

RICHARDSON & WRENCH LTD.
 Auctioneers 98 Pitt St. Sydney

with **ANDREW D. BADGERY**
 Auctioneer Moss Vale

DIAGRAM

TOWN OF MOSS VALE

VENDORS
THE INTERCOLONIAL INVESTMENT LAND & BUILDING COMPANY LTD
 14 Moore St. SYDNEY G. P. O.
 W. J. Douglas Manager

I ATCHISON & SCHLEICHER Licensed Surveyors
 Specially licensed under R.P. & Mining Acts
 Eldon Chambers 92 Pitt Street Sydney
 William Brooks & Co. Lth. SYDNEY
 All measurements & Areas subject to Dep. Plans

Sources Reviewed

- Exchanged Contract for Sale: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale.
- NSW LRS Title Search within contract, Folio 4/746930, search date 22 August 2023.
- DP746930 plan within contract, scanned page 44; subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513, registered 1987.
- Wingecarribee Shire Council Planning Certificate S10.724/0403, dated 25 August 2023, within contract.
- NSW Cadastre ArcGIS Feature Layer queried for planlabel=DP746930 and lotnumber=4.
- National Library of Australia: Moss Vale Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904. <https://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-230332818/view>
- National Library of Australia catalogue records for Austermere Estate / Moss Vale promotional subdivision material.
- State Library NSW Moss Vale subdivision plans list. <https://content-lists.sl.nsw.gov.au/tabular-list/moss-vale-subdivision-plans>
- NSW Spatial Services Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

Summary Position

Based on the evidence reviewed, the land at 6 Bulwer Road is strongly associated with a locality historically used and promoted for farming and agricultural purposes. The modern title and deposited plan place the land in the Parish of Bong Bong and in the Bulwer/Lytton Road area. The Austermere Estate material for this same historical locality records land as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms by 1904. On that basis, the evidence supports the conclusion that the land formed part of a historically rural and agricultural landscape and that clearing for farming/agricultural use had occurred in the area by at least 1904.

Caveat

This report is an evidence summary prepared from available documents and public research material. It is not legal advice, a registered survey, a contamination assessment, or a formal historical land-use assessment. A solicitor, surveyor, environmental consultant or title search specialist should be engaged if the conclusions are to be used for legal, planning, financing or environmental due diligence purposes.

Parish Map and Crown Plan Review Addendum

This addendum reviews digitised Parish of Bong Bong maps and the contract title/plan material to help assess whether the 6 Bulwer Road locality was historically rural, agricultural, farmed or cleared for farming purposes.

Summary finding. The 1942 and 1968 Parish of Bong Bong maps support the view that the Bulwer/Lytton Road locality sat within a broader rural cadastral landscape made up of large acreages and named holdings. This adds support to the farming/agricultural history already shown in the 1904 Austermere material.

Map Sources Reviewed

Source	Relevant details	Relevance
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1942, 8th edition	Department of Lands parish map. NLA identifier nla.obj-233787591. Shows Moss Vale, Bong Bong parish, large rural holdings, road alignments and parish numbers.	Confirms rural parish portions and large acreages before modern industrial subdivision.
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, 9th edition	Department of Lands parish map. NLA identifier nla.obj-537799794. Cadastral map showing parish boundaries and land holdings.	Shows continuing rural/parish landholding context around Moss Vale and Bulwer/Lytton.
Contract DP746930 plan	Shows DP746930 was a subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 and places the modern parcel in the Lytton/Bulwer road area.	Provides modern-to-parent-plan bridge needed to compare with parish map location.

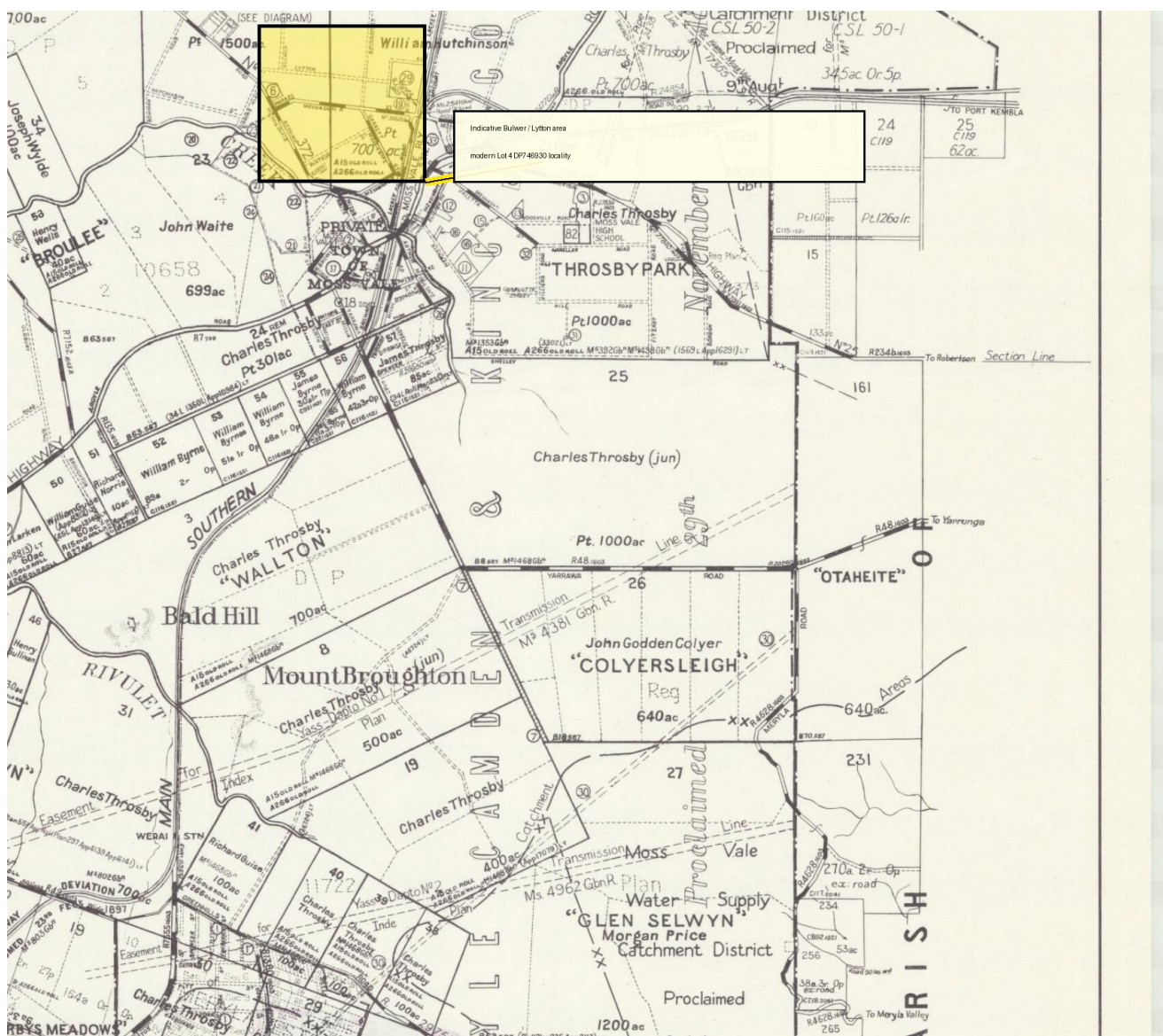
Parish Map Observations

- The maps show the Moss Vale locality in the context of older parish portions, old roll references and large acreage holdings, not as modern industrial land.
- Nearby holdings include William Hutchinson, John Waite, Charles Throsby, William Byrne and Throsby Park landholdings ranging from hundreds to around 1000 acres.
- The indicative Bulwer/Lytton position sits beside the older Moss Vale township and adjacent to large-acreage parish land, including a “Pt 700ac” area shown on the 1968 parish map.
- The parish-map review strengthens the historical farming/agricultural position by confirming the Bong Bong parish link, showing older rural landholding patterns, and aligning with the Austermere Estate evidence of cleared/ploughable agricultural land by 1904.

Addendum sources: NLA Parish of Bong Bong 1942 and 1968 maps; contract title search for Folio 4/746930; DP746930 plan extract.

Indicative Parish Map Extract

The highlighted area below is an indicative Bulwer/Lytton locality position on the 1968 Parish of Bong Bong map, used for orientation against the modern Lot 4 DP746930 location. It is not a surveyed overlay.



Source image: Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, Department of Lands, NLA object nla.obj-537799794; annotation prepared for this review.



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Historical Aerials

Source: NSW Spatial Services - Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

1979, 1989, 1991 and 1997 tighter oval-focused clean aerial extracts, ordered earliest to latest.

Corrected view: 08/01/1979 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 25/02/1989 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 23/09/1991 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 24/09/1991 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 21/01/1997 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Oval-focused clean extract; not a surveyed overlay.



Final image retained on the same page and zoomed in to match the rest of the aerial set.